

**CEO BRIEF**

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Sema AI is national language infrastructure for inclusive AI.

Kenya is multilingual, but most AI, digital services, and voice systems still work best in English or generic Kiswahili. Sema AI closes that gap by building verified Kenyan language text, translation, speech, review, and dataset infrastructure.

The core problem: millions of Kenyans are digitally reachable but linguistically underserved.

68+

Kenyan languages need representation in AI systems, not only English and Kiswahili.

80-90%+

Potential population benefit when local language access is added to public and private services.

5 of 68

Recent Kenyan speech datasets cover only a small fraction of the languages that need support.

What Problem Are We Solving?

Sema AI solves language exclusion in AI. A person should be able to access healthcare, education, civic information, business tools, customer support, and voice interfaces in the language they understand best. Today, most systems either ignore Kenyan local languages or treat them as an afterthought.

FOR CITIZENS**FOR INSTITUTIONS**

People can translate, hear, record, and validate information in local languages, lowering the barrier to digital services for rural, elderly, first-time internet, and non-English-first users.

Counties, clinics, schools, banks, NGOs, media teams, and call centers gain verified language data for translation, transcription, voice support, and AI assistants.

FOR AI BUILDERS

Sema becomes the structured data layer: corpus items, translations, recordings, speaker metadata, quality review, consent, and export-ready datasets.

FOR KENYA

Kenyan languages become first-class citizens in modern technology instead of being locked out of the next generation of AI products.

Who Benefits?

Based on Kenya's 2019 census population distribution, the largest native language communities alone represent roughly 43.2 million people out of 47.6 million, or about 91% of the country.

LANGUAGE COMMUNITY	APPROX. POPULATION	BENEFIT FROM SEMA AI
Kikuyu	8.1M	Translation, speech, education, public-service access
Luhya	6.8M	Local language corpus, voice data, review workflows
Kalenjin	6.4M	Language-specific AI training data and voice support
Dholuo	5.1M	Translation, transcription, healthcare and civic access
Kamba	4.7M	Verified text, audio, and community review
Somali, Gusii, Mijikenda, Meru, Maasai, Turkana	12.1M+	Inclusion in AI systems beyond English-first design

Why Is It Worth Building?

- **Healthcare:** patients can describe symptoms and receive guidance in familiar languages.
- **Government:** public services become easier to access for more citizens.
- **Education:** learners can get explanations in languages they understand.
- **Agriculture and SMEs:** farmers and small businesses can receive practical advice locally.
- **Enterprise:** banks, call centers, media, and NGOs need verified Kenyan language data.
- **AI infrastructure:** Sema creates datasets that future Kenyan AI products can depend on.

CEO positioning: Sema AI is not just a contributor portal. It is the Kenyan language data and voice infrastructure platform for inclusive AI.

Evidence of the Gap

Existing research confirms progress, but also shows how much remains uncovered. Kencorpus covers Swahili, Dholuo, and Luhya with 5.6M words and 177 hours of speech. AfriVoices-KE covers five Kenyan languages with about 3,000 hours of audio. Both are valuable, but Kenya has dozens more languages that need production-grade text, translation, audio, and review coverage.

One-Sentence Answer

Sema AI gives Kenya's languages the verified data infrastructure they need to work inside modern AI, benefiting citizens, institutions, and technology builders across the country.

Sources: Languages of Kenya: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Languages_of_Kenya · Kenya demographics/census summary: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Demographics_of_Kenya · Kencorpus: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2208.12081> · AfriVoices-KE: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2604.08448> · State of NLP in Kenya: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2410.09948>